Backup Single Pane of Glass: Presenter Briefing

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The deck argues that Azure Backup protects core data well in region, but no copy sits outside the production tenant and identity, code and platform configuration have no customer-controlled backup, so recovering from a major outage depends on things not yet in place.

Storyline and numbers to remember

Your session has four objectives; the deck covers the first two well and the last two only partly.

Session objective	Where the deck covers it	Strength
Review the current state	Slides 2 and 3	Strong
Understand the gaps	Slides 3, 4 and 5	Strong
Discuss the desired state	Slides 6 and 7 (the three preconditions and the recovery sequence)	Partial: no explicit target state, no recovery targets
Highlight areas needing attention	Grey box on slide 7, plus "to be confirmed" notes throughout	Partial: no owners, decisions or next steps

The argument in four steps:

1. Azure Backup is good at the first layer: a protected copy of core data in Canada Central.
2. Every offsite copy today is a geo-replica administered inside the same tenant, so none is isolated.
3. Identity (Entra ID), code (GitHub, Azure DevOps) and platform configuration have only short native retention and no customer-controlled backup. Recovery of everything else depends on them.

4. A third-party platform adds isolation, long-term retention and, with Commvault, automated rebuild. It does not remove the need for Entra ID, a reachable Azure control plane and capacity in a recovery region.

Numbers to have in your head

- 24 workload types assessed (October 2026): 3 protected by Azure Backup without conditions, 8 with conditions, 7 by the service's own backup, 4 rebuilt from code, 2 needing a complement.
- 0 copies administered outside the production tenant.
- 7 services with no customer-controlled backup.
- Native retention windows: Entra ID backup 7 days, Entra recycle bin 30 days, Azure DevOps deleted projects 28 days, GitHub deleted repositories 90 days, PaaS databases 7 to 35 days.
- Timing: the speaker notes say about twelve minutes for six content slides. Slides 3 and 6 are dense tables, so decide now which rows you will skip aloud.

Slide 1 and 2: opening and the three-layer model

Slide 1: Title

Say: This is a coverage review, not a vendor pitch. We start from what Azure protects today, test it against three outage types and the services everything depends on, then show what a third-party platform adds and what it does not.

- **Q: Why are we doing this now?** The deck does not state a trigger. The evidence base is the October 2026 Azure environment assessment; add your own business reason (audit, incident, programme) before you present.
- **Q: The title says single pane of glass. Where is it?** It appears only as the last row of slide 6. Frame it as the outcome: once every workload has a defined protection method and an isolated copy, one console can show status and drive recovery. Coverage comes first, the console second.
- **Q: Are we choosing a vendor today?** No. Both are shown from vendor documentation and are to be confirmed in a proof of concept. The Key Decision Document and requirements come in a later session.

Slide 2: What enterprise backup coverage is

Key message: Three layers (protect, isolate, recover). Azure Backup does layer 1 well; layers 2 and 3 are where the gaps are.

- **Q: Why not just rely on Azure Backup?** For core data in region it is strong. The gaps are an isolated copy, and identity, code and platform configuration, which it does not cover.
- **Q: Isn't the Canada East geo-replica our offsite copy?** It is a copy in another location, but it is administered in the same tenant with the same credentials. A compromised administrator can reach both. Zone redundancy is availability, not isolation.
- **Q: Doesn't an immutable vault with Multi-User Authorization fix that?** It raises the bar and is worth enabling. The deck says it reduces the dependency but does not remove it. Microsoft documents that the second-approver Resource Guard can sit in a different subscription (I believe also a different tenant; verify before claiming either way). The data still lives in the same Azure platform.
- **Q: A service "not covered" by Azure Backup sounds like a gap.** Not by itself. SQL Database, Cosmos DB, Key Vault and Entra ID have built-in backup; Logic Apps and Data Factory are meant to be redeployed from code. The gap is short retention and no isolated copy.
- **Q: What is the rule of thumb?** The 3-2-1-1-0 pattern: three copies, two storage types, one offsite, one immutable, zero restore errors (tested restores).

Watch-out: slide 2 calls built-in backup for Entra ID "not a weakness", while slides 3 and 5 count Entra ID beyond 7 days as a gap. Be ready to reconcile: built-in backup exists, but is short and in the same service.

Slide 3: What is protected today, and what is not

Key message: Most data is well protected in region. The exposure is in retention length, isolation, and the rebuild-from-code and SaaS rows.

How to read the table: left to right, how it is protected, whether a Canadian offsite copy exists, what is not captured. Colours: green Azure Backup, blue the service's own backup, amber protected with conditions, grey rebuilt from code, red a gap. The colour key is only in your speaker notes, not on the slide, so say it aloud.

The three tiles

- **3 of 24:** workload types protected by Azure Backup without conditions (VMs, SQL Server on VMs, Azure Files); 8 with conditions; 7 by the service's own backup; 4 are rebuilt from code and 2 need a complement (3 + 8 + 7 + 4 + 2 = 24). The 24 come from table 1.1.1 of the Key Decision Document, which is not in the deck.
- **0:** no copy is administered outside the production tenant; every offsite copy is a same-tenant geo-replica.
- **7:** Logic Apps, Data Factory, AI Foundry, platform configuration, Azure DevOps, GitHub, and Entra ID beyond 7 days.

Likely questions

- **Q: What does "Partial" mean?** Protection depends on configuration or hosting plan: for example uniform scale sets only, disk snapshots in the same subscription, Archive-tier blobs excluded, AKS Azure Disk volumes only.
- **Q: Which gap matters most?** Entra ID, GitHub and Azure DevOps, because platform configuration is rebuilt from code, code lives in the DevOps platforms, and both sign in with Entra ID (slide 5).
- **Q: Is 7 to 35 days of native PaaS retention enough?** It depends on retention obligations (regulatory, contractual, audit), which the deck does not state. Ask whoever owns records retention and bring the answer to the requirements session.
- **Q: Are our vaults GRS today?** The slide says "if vault is GRS" and "statuses to be confirmed per subscription". Cross Region Restore needs GRS set at vault creation, so this is an open verification item.
- **Q: Is "0 copies" really true? We have a Commvault estate.** Slide 4 mentions an existing on-premises Commvault estate. The 0 refers to Azure workloads. Confirm before the session that no Azure workload is already copied to it.

Watch-out: the number 7 appears twice on this slide with different meanings (7 protected by the service's own backup, and 7 with no customer-controlled backup). Say which you mean each time.

Slide 4: What stops working, by outage type

Key message: Backups that live only in Azure share Azure's failure modes. The design handles a zone outage; a region outage and an Azure-wide or Entra ID outage are not covered by a tested plan.

Walk the columns

- **Zone outage:** absorbed by zone-redundant design. Nothing to add.
- **Region outage (Canada Central):** production is down until restored or failed over. Backups replicate to Canada East only if vaults are GRS, Cross Region Restore covers supported workloads only, and nothing runs in Canada East today, so compute capacity is not assured.
- **Azure-wide or Entra ID outage:** worst case. Portal, Resource Manager and every Entra sign-in stop, so even backup consoles are unreachable without break-glass access.
- **Last row:** on-premises and the existing Commvault estate are independent of Azure. That is why an on-premises copy has value.

Likely questions

- **Q: How likely is each scenario?** The deck does not rate likelihood or impact. Offer to add that; it is how the business will prioritise.
- **Q: Why are "Azure-wide" and "Entra ID" one column?** Both break sign-in, and Resource Manager and the portal authenticate through Entra ID. It is a worst-case view; a real Entra-only event may affect workloads unevenly.
- **Q: Do we have capacity in Canada East?** Not guaranteed. Options are capacity reservations or a standing minimal footprint; both cost money, so this is a decision for the requirements session.
- **Q: Is a region outage realistic?** Rare, but it is the scenario that exposes capacity, Cross Region Restore limits and console dependencies all at once, which is why it is worth designing for.
- **Q: Does GitHub survive?** Yes for a Canada Central outage (global, independent of any Azure region), but not for an Entra SSO failure if sign-in uses Entra.

Watch-out: statuses assume current configuration and are unconfirmed per service. Do not state any cell as verified.

Slide 5: The services everything else depends on

Key message: Microsoft gives more native protection than people expect, but all of it is short-term, held inside the service being recovered, and cannot handle hard deletion or a compromised administrator.

Say the dependency chain aloud: platform configuration is rebuilt from code, the code lives in GitHub or Azure DevOps, and both sign in with Entra ID. Protecting identity and code is a precondition for recovering anything else.

Service	What exists natively	The gap
Entra ID	Recycle bin 30 days; Entra Backup and Recovery (GA June 2026) daily tamper-proof backups, 7 days, included with P1/P2	Hard-deleted objects unrecoverable; nothing beyond 7 days; a compromised Global Administrator is outside the design
GitHub Enterprise Cloud	Deleted repositories restorable for 90 days by an organisation owner	No customer-controlled or point-in-time backup; issues, pull requests, Actions and permissions not restored
Azure DevOps Services	Deleted projects restorable for 28 days	Repositories, pipelines, work items and wikis have no customer-controlled backup
Platform configuration	Locks, Azure Policy, Key Vault soft delete and purge protection	No undelete for resource groups or networks; depends on complete, tested IaC
PaaS databases	Built-in point-in-time restore, 7 to 35 days	Short retention, same tenant; no long-term or isolated copy

Likely questions

- **Q: Microsoft now backs up Entra ID. Isn't that solved?** It is a real improvement and is free with P1/P2, so turn it on. But it is 7 days, inside the service we would be recovering, and does not cover hard-deleted objects.
- **Q: Doesn't Microsoft protect GitHub and Azure DevOps?** Microsoft keeps the service running and restores deleted items for a limited time. It does not give you a backup you control and can restore from after corruption or malicious change.
- **Q: What is the worst realistic scenario?** A compromised Global Administrator who deletes or alters identity, repositories and pipelines together. Native recovery assumes that does not happen.
- **Q: Is IaC complete today?** The deck does not say. This is an open question to put to the platform team: coverage of critical environments, whether it has been tested by a rebuild, and where it is stored.

Watch-out: Entra Backup and Recovery being generally available is confirmed by a Microsoft Tech Community post I opened. The June 2026 date and 7-day window match what secondary sources report, but I could not read them on Microsoft's own page; confirm on Microsoft Learn before quoting.

Slide 6: How a third-party platform closes the gaps

Key message: Both platforms add an isolated copy and long-term retention for identity, code and PaaS. Only Commvault adds automated rebuild of environments. Neither removes the need for Entra ID, a reachable Azure control plane and capacity in the recovery region. Only a copy held outside Azure removes the storage dependency.

Do not oversell. Every capability is from vendor documentation and is to be confirmed in a proof of concept. The deck does not recommend a vendor.

Likely questions

- **Q: Which one is better?** Not decided here. The difference that matters most to the gaps: Commvault Cloud Rewind rebuilds resource groups, VNets and compute; Rubrik does not, so it relies on IaC. Rubrik's Azure DevOps protection is generally available; its GitHub scope is still to confirm.
- **Q: Does either vendor's vault avoid Azure?** Only if placed elsewhere: Commvault AirGap Protect on OCI or GCP, Rubrik Cloud Vault on Google Cloud, or an on-premises copy. The default Canadian vaults are Azure-hosted in a vendor-managed tenant.
- **Q: Is the data kept in Canada?** The deck says Canadian residency of vendor control planes is to be confirmed. Data vault locations are stated as Canadian; control-plane residency is the open point, so involve privacy and legal early.
- **Q: Can Cloud Rewind rebuild in another region?** The deck says same region for selected resources and "confirm cross-region". I checked Commvault's documentation: whole assemblies or selected resource groups can be recovered to a recovery region (compute, storage, load balancers), creating a new resource group. SQL, MySQL and PostgreSQL recovery is same-region and same-resource-group only, an Azure limitation. Say this is from documentation and a PoC must prove it.
- **Q: Known Cloud Rewind limits?** From the same page: VM extensions and autoscale settings are not recovered, storage accounts attached to compute are not recovered, SQL servers cannot be restored (only databases, into the same server), and PaaS database recovery needs Azure backups enabled.

- **Q: What is the AWS reference?** AWS appears only on this slide and nowhere else in the deck. Have an answer ready on whether AWS is in scope; otherwise it reads as a stray.
- **Q: Does a vendor console solve the Entra ID outage problem?** No. Both consoles use Entra SSO, so each needs vendor-local break-glass accounts. The self-hosted CommServe on-premises is Azure-independent.

Watch-out: Rubrik GitHub support "announced March 2026" is the deck's claim. Rubrik's November 2025 post I opened said GitHub would come "in upcoming quarters" with no date, and I could not verify March 2026. Treat it as unconfirmed.

Slide 7: Getting the business back after a major Azure outage

Key message: Recovery runs in dependency order (control, identity, foundation, data, validation), and each step needs something that must exist before the outage. This slide is your desired state.

The three preconditions

1. An isolated copy: immutable, in a second Canadian location or on-premises, administered outside production and primary-backup credentials.
2. A recovery region plan: capacity in Canada East or an alternate subscription, tested at least annually, plus break-glass identities.
3. Code and identity recoverable: IaC for critical environments, with the repositories and Entra ID themselves backed up.

The sequence: 0 regain control (minutes to hours), 1 recover identity (hours), 2 rebuild the foundation (hours), 3 restore data by tier (hours to a day per tier), 4 validate and cut over (per runbook).

The four things that would make recovery fail: an offsite copy a compromised administrator can delete; no reserved capacity or alternate subscription; IaC that is incomplete or held only in a repository that is itself lost; no identity that works when Entra ID does not. Each maps to a gap on slides 3 to 5 and each needs an owner.

Likely questions

- **Q: What are the RTO and RPO?** Not set. Timings are indicative and the targets are to be agreed with the business. Do not quote the hours as commitments.

- **Q: Who owns each of the four failure points?** Not named in the deck. This is the most useful thing to leave the session with: propose owners, or ask the room to nominate them.
- **Q: Is an alternate subscription in Canada Central a region-outage answer?** No. It helps if the primary subscription or tenant is compromised or locked, not if Canada Central is down. Canada East capacity is the region-outage answer.
- **Q: How do we sign in when Entra ID is down?** Be careful. Azure and the portal always need Entra ID, so "identities that do not depend on Entra ID" cannot literally reach Azure during a true Entra outage. What can work is cloud-only emergency accounts that avoid federation, MFA and Conditional Access dependencies (which survive misconfiguration, not a service outage), vendor-local accounts for third-party consoles, and an on-premises CommServe and AD. See the issues list.
- **Q: How often will we test?** The deck says at least annually. Ask whether that is frequent enough for tier-0 and tier-1 systems.
- **Q: Is the sequence the same for ransomware?** Broadly yes, but step 0 becomes confirming the last clean recovery point and rotating compromised credentials, which the deck mentions only briefly.

Issues to fix or be ready for

These are inconsistencies and weak points I found reading the deck against itself and against vendor documentation. Ordered by how likely they are to draw a challenge.

#	Slide	Issue	Suggested handling
1	7 (also 4, 6)	"Break-glass identities that do not depend on Entra ID" cannot reach Azure during a true Entra outage, because Azure sign-in always uses Entra ID.	Reword to cloud-only emergency accounts, vendor-local console accounts and on-premises access. State plainly that a full Entra outage blocks Azure itself.
2	6 vs 7	Slide 6 says Cloud Rewind selected-resource recovery is same-region; slide 7 step 2 has it rebuilding in the recovery region.	Per Commvault documentation, compute, storage and load balancers can be recovered cross-region; SQL, MySQL and PostgreSQL cannot. Align both slides and mark it for PoC.

#	Slide	Issue	Suggested handling
3	2 vs 3 and 5	Slide 2 says Logic Apps, Data Factory, Key Vault and Entra ID "not covered" is not a weakness; slide 3 counts the same items in the "7 with no customer-controlled backup".	Explain: by design they need no backup, but the dependency on complete, tested, backed-up IaC is the gap. Or relabel the tile.
4	3	"7" is used for two different counts on one slide.	Rename one tile or say which each time.
5	3	The 24-type count and the colour key are not on the slide.	Add the colour key; cite table 1.1.1 in the footnote.
6	3 and 4	"0 copies outside the tenant" is stated absolutely, yet an on-premises Commvault estate exists.	Confirm no Azure workload already copies to it, or scope the claim to Azure workloads.
7	7	Alternate subscription in Canada Central is listed beside Canada East as a recovery region plan. It protects against account compromise, not region loss.	Split into two named scenarios.
8	6	AWS and "one console across AWS" appear nowhere else.	Remove, or explain scope.
9	6	Rubrik GitHub "announced March 2026" could not be verified; Rubrik's Nov 2025 post gave no date.	Verify with Rubrik or soften to "roadmap".
10	4	Three scenarios have no likelihood or business-impact rating.	Add a simple rating or be ready to say it comes later.
11	1 and 7	Notes refer to the Key Decision Document and to requirements, neither of which is visible in the deck.	Add a line saying where they will be introduced.
12	all	The title promises a single pane of glass, but only one row of one slide addresses it.	Add a sentence in the opening on how the console fits the coverage story.

Areas needing further attention

The deck ends without a desired-state summary or next steps. These are the items to raise or propose so the session finishes with decisions rather than only findings.

Area	Current state	Desired state	Open question or owner needed
Isolated copy	Same-tenant geo-replicas only	Immutable copy outside production credentials, Canada or on-premises	Owner; where it lives; Canadian residency
Identity	Entra native backup, 7 days	Long-term backup held outside the tenant; emergency access that works	Owner; enable Entra Backup and Recovery now
Code and IaC	Native retention 28 to 90 days; IaC completeness unknown	Repositories backed up; IaC complete, tested, recoverable	IaC coverage audit; owner
Recovery region	No workloads or reserved capacity in Canada East	Tested capacity or alternate subscription	Cost decision; annual test minimum
Retention	PaaS 7 to 35 days	Retention matching obligations	Records and compliance requirement
Recovery targets	Not defined	Business-signed RTO and RPO per tier	Business owners
Vendor control plane	Residency unconfirmed	Confirmed Canadian residency	Privacy and legal
Verification	Statuses unconfirmed per subscription	Confirmed GRS vaults, partial rows and PaaS coverage	Platform team

Suggested close: ask the room to agree the four failure points on slide 7 as the shared problem statement, nominate an owner for each, and confirm that the requirements session and proof of concept are the next steps. I can draft a closing slide for the deck if

you want one.

Sources

The deck's own figures come from your slides (October 2026 assessment). Pages I opened to check vendor claims:

- Commvault Cloud Rewind: Azure Recovery: cross-region recovery for compute, storage and load balancers; same-region limits for SQL, MySQL and PostgreSQL; unrecovered items.
- Rubrik: DevOps Protection for Azure DevOps: Azure DevOps support from December 2025 (the page's description says November); GitHub "in upcoming quarters".
- Microsoft Entra Backup and Recovery is now generally available: confirms general availability and inclusion in Entra P1 and P2; the retention window was not readable on that page.

Not checked: Microsoft Learn pages on Entra retention, Azure Backup limits, GitHub and Azure DevOps retention, and Commvault's August 2026 Cloud Rewind expansion (seen only as headlines).